

Scope of practice & referral pathway

Module 3 handout. Pair with Lesson 5.

In scope (Essentials stylist)

- ? Observe hair and scalp during normal services
- ? Describe findings in plain English
- ? Adapt water temperature, products, tension, and chemical plans for comfort and integrity
- ? Recognise common pictures (sensitive scalp, flake/build-up, traction clues, shed vs breakage, pattern vs patch)
- ? Recommend supportive products/services without cure claims
- ? Guide toward trichologist or GP when needed
- ? Note observations factually for continuity

Out of scope

- ? Diagnosing medical disease
- ? Interpreting blood tests
- ? Prescribing or advising prescription medicines
- ? Cure claims for alopecia, psoriasis, infection, autoimmune disease, and similar
- ? Continuing irritating or invasive steps on broken / severely inflamed scalp
- ? Ignoring red flags to protect a sale

Red flags (stop, soften, refer)

- ? Patchy bald areas
- ? Sudden severe shed
- ? Painful, weeping, or pustular scalp
- ? Rapidly spreading inflammation
- ? Possible scarring appearance
- ? Any case where you feel out of your depth

Referral script

"I'd like you to have this checked by a trichologist or your GP. I can keep your salon care gentle in the meantime."

Documentation (brief)

- ? What you saw (observation words only)
- ? What you adapted today
- ? Referral advice given
- ? Avoid firm diagnostic labels you cannot stand behind

Academy vs clinic (keep distinct)

- ? The Trichology Academy (trichologyacademy.co.uk): education for professionals
- ? Clinic: Loz sees clients in Knutsford; access via the Academy loop when referral fits
- ? Completing Essentials does not make a stylist a clinician

Professional reminder

Referral is not failure. Clear boundaries protect clients and deepen trust.